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Aman Gupta • Feb 21, 2025 (Edited Feb 22, 2025)

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(Each question is of 2 marks)

1. What information must an entity possess before it can verify the public-key certificate of user X issued by 'certification authority', CA?

- The Private key of the "Certification Authority, CA"
- **The Public key of the "Certification Authority, CA" (correct)**
- The public-key of user X
- None of the above

2. What information must an entity possess before it can seek and obtain the public key of another user X from the "Public-Key Authority", PKA?

- The Private key of the "Public-Key Authority", PKA
- **The Public key of the "Public-Key Authority", PKA (correct)**
- Login-ID and Password of the "Public-Key Authority", PKA.
- None of the above

3. What is the big advantage of using a "Certification Authority" to generate & distribute Public-key certificates as opposed to seeking public keys from a trusted "Public-Key Authority"?

- There may be multiple Certification Authorities whereas that is not the case with Public-Key Authorities
- **The computing and communication load on a Certification Authority will be significantly lowered given that Certificates can be exchanged by communicating entities without involving the Certification Authority (correct)**
- There is no advantage of using a "Certification Authority" over a "Public-Key Authority"
- None of the above

4. Let an entity A seek to obtain the public-key of another entity B using the public-key certificate of entity B signed by a certification authority CA. Which of the statements below is most appropriate?



- Entity A need not necessarily possess the public-key of CA
- **Entity A need not possess the public-key of CA provided A can somehow obtain the public-key of CA (correct)**

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